



**“Amidst tough times, we introduced a new range of vehicles, revamped distribution strategy and proactively led the EV journey in the country”**

**P.B. BALAJI**  
GROUP CFO, TATA MOTORS



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**GAURAV VANGAAL**  
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**“The company’s biggest challenge will be to sustain market share in the face of intensifying competition”**

**HIMANSHU SINGH**  
RESEARCH ANALYST,  
PRABHUDAS LILLADHER

says Chandra. “Tiago EV is a very feature-rich vehicle. Our production processes have matured. We have sold nearly 70,000 EVs by now. These learnings help us stay ahead of the curve,” a confident Chandra adds.

With scorching competition in the \$1.45-billion (₹11,881 crore) and growing Indian EV market, the journey ahead may not be easy for Tata Motors. Another home-grown automaker, Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M), too, is planning to launch its first EV, XUV400, early next year. “Both Tata Motors and M&M are well placed to compete in the SUV and EV space. M&M has been very successful with its last few launches like XUV700. And both are well placed to ride on their gained market share. I don’t see them cannibalising each other’s markets for now. Tata Motors will aggressively accelerate its journey in electrification,” Singh says.

However, a confident Balaji expects Tata Motors’

nimble approach to help it battle challenges both in the EV and SUV space. “We have been agile in managing our supply chain, including semiconductor shortages, stepping up investments in capacity through targeted de-bottlenecking and doubling down on the safety of our vehicles. Due to these efforts, our market shares have increased multi-fold and our margins have grown steadily. The PV business is now cash positive, whilst the EV business is well funded to invest in line with our aspirations,” he says.

Experts point out that India will see a mix of alternative fuel technologies like hydrogen, flex fuel, CNG, hybrids, etc. and Tata Motors is mindful of that. “We’re not betting only on one technology. Our next 5 million will come from a mix of ICE, which is still going to grow. CNG will also grow while flex-fuel will be mandated by the government. There will be other adjacent technologies along with electrification. In the high-end SUVs, diesel might still remain,” Chandra says.

According to Vangaal, the company needs to look at fresh investments for its new skateboard platform, considered to be the best for EVs, to develop these new technologies. “They need to launch the skateboard platform in the next three years and for that R&D of sophisticated technologies is required. It’s about how quickly they can raise funds and keep up with their product launch timelines,” he says.

Tata Motors is currently working on a three-platform strategy that will underpin the company’s line-up for the next decade. And the success of its next 5 million target is heavily dependent on how quickly it is able to integrate these platforms—that includes a converted IC (internal combustion) engine platform, a bespoke EV platform and eventually, a skateboard (which will be launched in three distinct phases). With a lot on his plate, Chandra, meanwhile, likes to march ahead with laser-sharp focus. “We did not work with a rank in our mind. It’s welcome but not something we’re obsessed about. We just want to concentrate on growing the acceptance of our vehicles and make sure we’re in the Top 3 in all the segments we play in,” he says.

“The company [Tata Motors] has become quite aggressive on an annual basis. Even if they don’t see any growth, then the figure of the next 5 million should be achieved in 10 years. I don’t think it’s very difficult to achieve that number sooner,” says Prabhudas Lilladher’s Singh.

Surely, Tata Motors has put its pedal to the metal. The journey is going to be interesting, so fasten your seat belts and enjoy the ride! **BT**

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